

Battery Care Instructions

1. Overview

These instructions help you keep the vehicle battery in good condition, prevent premature failure, and maintain reliable starting performance. Regular care protects both the battery and the electrical system connected to it.

2. Basic Handling Guidelines

Safe Handling

- Always switch off the ignition before touching the battery.
- Wear gloves and eye protection when working around terminals.
- Avoid placing tools or metal objects on the battery surface to prevent accidental short circuits.
- Keep the area around the battery dry and clean.

Disconnecting the Battery

- Remove the negative terminal first.
 - Ensure no cables touch the bodywork once disconnected.
 - When reconnecting, attach the positive terminal first, then the negative.
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3. Routine Maintenance

Visual Inspection

Check the battery once every few weeks for:

- Cracks, swelling, or leakage
- Loose or corroded terminals
- Dust or moisture buildup
- Damaged insulation on nearby cables

Cleaning

If you see corrosion:

1. Disconnect the battery safely.
2. Clean terminals using a brush and mild baking-soda solution.

3. Rinse carefully and dry completely.
4. Reconnect and ensure all clamps are tight.

Charge Levels

- The battery should stay above 12.4 volts when idle.
 - If the voltage dips regularly, charge the battery using a recommended charger.
 - For vehicles not used often, consider a maintenance charger to prevent deep discharge.
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4. Usage Tips for Longer Battery Life

Driving Habits

- Short, frequent trips may prevent the alternator from fully charging the battery.
- Try to include longer drives periodically to maintain proper charging flow.

Electrical Load

- Switch off lights, heated screens, and accessories before shutting down the vehicle.
- Avoid running the infotainment system or accessories with the engine off for long periods.

Temperature Effects

- Extreme cold slows battery performance.
 - Intense heat accelerates internal wear.
 - Park in shaded or sheltered areas when possible.
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5. Storage and Long-Term Parking

If the vehicle will sit unused for more than two weeks:

- Disconnect the negative terminal or use a trickle charger.
 - Store the vehicle in a cool, dry place.
 - Avoid letting the battery discharge completely, as deep cycles shorten its life significantly.
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6. When to Replace the Battery

Signs that the battery may be nearing end of life:

- Slow cranking when starting the engine
- Frequent jump-starts
- Dim headlights at idle
- Warning messages on the instrument cluster
- Visible swelling, leakage, or strong sulfur smell

If any of these appear, test the battery and replace it promptly to avoid electrical faults.

7. Safety Reminders

- Never smoke or create sparks near a battery.
- Do not attempt to open or repair the battery casing.
- Dispose of old batteries through authorised recycling facilities only.